

Belmont Orthodontics

Consent to Orthodontic Treatment

It is important that you understand the orthodontic treatment proposed, its duration and the risks involved.

Orthodontic treatment is an elective procedure. After details have been explained it is up to the patient and/or parents to decide if it is appropriate for them.

Reading and understanding this consent form is an important step for anyone planning to undergo orthodontic treatment in this practice. Please read it carefully and sign it only if you are happy with the content and you understand the commitment it places on you or your child.

The duration of treatment depends on the severity of the presenting complaint and the co-operation of the patient with the orthodontist. Generally, treatment takes between 18 and 24 months. This may vary due to poor co-operation, complexity of treatment or unexpected factors such as unfavourable growth.

PATIENT CO-OPERATION

This is possibly the most important factor for completing treatment on time and with the least possible side effects. Poor co-operation can lengthen treatment and affect the quality of the final result. Poor cooperation also includes but is not limited to missing appointments or failure to follow advice or instructions offered.

The patient's responsibility: It is the patient's responsibility to follow the brushing and oral hygiene instructions that are given, so that no harm will come to the teeth and surrounding tissues; to come to all appointments on the proper day and time; to adhere to the list of food restrictions in order to keep from damaging the teeth, orthodontic appliance and retainers, so that treatment time will be as short as possible and we can achieve the best results; and to visit the general dentist at least every six months for an examination and cleaning.

There will be charges for replacement of appliances (such as retainers or braces) that are lost or damaged due to neglect. 100% patient co-operation is very important.

DECALCIFICATION

It is important to follow the written and verbal oral hygiene instructions you are given. Failure to do so can result in discolouration of the visible surfaces of the teeth (decalcification) or decay.

ROOT RESORPTION AND ROOT PROBLEMS

In most cases of orthodontic treatment the roots of the teeth shorten very slightly. In rare cases the roots shorten dramatically. An X-ray is normally taken at the start of treatment to assess the likelihood of severe root resorption.

Previous tooth injury can also make the teeth more susceptible. You will be advised if you are at higher risk than normal. It will not always be possible to determine the risk involved and in some cases severe root resorption occurs despite an apparent low risk to begin with. This is regrettable but fortunately also very rare.

Ankylosis of teeth is a rare occurrence associated with the roots of teeth. In cases where teeth have been damaged, or when teeth are being moved long distances or even for no apparent reason, these teeth become fused to the bone and they cannot be moved. In rare circumstances they have to be removed altogether and this too can compromise treatment outcomes.

NERVE DAMAGE AND TOOTH DISCOLOURATION

Rarely orthodontic treatment may cause the death of the nerve of a tooth. Usually this is not an isolated event but associated with a previous, perhaps even forgotten trauma to the tooth. This nerve death usually manifests itself as discolouration of the tooth. It is treated by root treatment and bleaching both of which are straightforward procedures.

TEMPRO-MANDIBULAR JOINTS (TMJ)

This is the set of joints on which your lower jaw hinges. There is very little evidence to suggest that orthodontic treatment causes a problem in these joints. Most people with TMJ problems have never had orthodontic treatment and stress or tension appears to play a role in the frequency and severity of joint pains. There are also many other causes of TMJ dysfunction.

Tooth alignment or bite correction sometimes can improve tooth related causes of TMJ pain, but this is not in all cases.

FACIAL GROWTH

Many orthodontic problems are as a result of disharmony between the jaws as a result of growth. Orthodontics in many cases is aimed at disguising these discrepancies. Despite our best efforts and planning sometimes patients do not follow a normal growth pattern and treatment results are affected adversely. If growth becomes disproportionate, the jaw relation can be affected and original treatment objectives may have to be compromised. Skeletal growth disharmony is a biologic process beyond the orthodontist's control. Some orthodontic patients will require oral surgery to obtain a reasonable treatment result to complete their case. Most patients we can inform ahead of time prior to starting any treatment that this might be necessary. Some patients with poor growth, poor response to treatment, or poor co-operation may also require oral surgery to complete their cases.

GUM TISSUES

The bone-gum relationship around teeth is always dependent upon whether there is enough bone to support the gum tissue properly. Many times when very crowded teeth are straightened there is a lack of bone and supporting gum tissues surrounding the teeth. Therefore, the gum tissue contour and support may not be adequate and this may require periodontal intervention. It is not always possible to avoid unwanted problems with gums when we move teeth but we do try very hard to avoid any treatment induced problems.

TREATMENT TIME

The total time for treatment can be extended beyond our estimate. Lack of co-operation, broken appliances and missed appointments are all important factors that could lengthen treatment time and affect the quality of the result. Occasionally teeth do not move as we might expect them to and while this is regrettable, it can lengthen the treatment significantly. In some cases we are forced to compromise on the outcome as a result of this.

UNUSUAL OCCURENCES

Swallowed appliances, chipped teeth, dislodged restorations and allergies to latex or nickel rarely occur but are possible. Please let us know if you have any of these allergies.

TERMINATION OF TREATMENT

It is understood that treatment can be terminated for failure to cooperate, missing appointments, not wearing appliances, excessive breakage, failure to keep financial commitments, relocation, personal conflicts or for any other reason the doctor feels necessary. If termination is necessary, the patient will be given ample time to locate another orthodontist or the braces will be removed.

EXPECTATIONS

All orthodontic patients can expect improvement with their particular problem, but, in many cases, absolute perfection is impossible due to lack of muscle balance, tooth shapes and sizes and varying degrees of co-operation during treatment, along with heredity aspects that affects everyone's specific treatment results.

RELAPSE

This means the tendency for teeth to move after the brace has been withdrawn. Failure to wear your retainers as instructed will almost always result in relapse. In most cases you will be advised to continue your retention wear on reduced basis for an indefinite period if you wish to keep your teeth well aligned. We often offer fixed retainers after treatment has been completed. These are fine wires attached to the inside surfaces of your teeth where they cannot be seen. They are a robust method of maintaining the alignment, but the cost of this type of retainer is not always met by the NHS. We will inform you whether you are likely to receive one of these retainers on the NHS. If not we will offer it as a paid option.

Appointments are made to facilitate your treatment. If you fail to keep appointments we reserve the right to impose a fine or terminate treatment for persistent poor attendance. A missed appointment inconveniences everyone and it prolongs your treatment.

We realise that for some people appointments during school hour's present difficulties. We are sympathetic but if you decide to have treatment then you must accept that most of your appointments will be during school hours. As the majority of our patients are of school age this will be the case for nearly everyone.

The practice staff is employed by us to facilitate the smooth running of the practice. Please treat them with the same courtesy you are shown.

Once your brace has been fitted you must attend the practice at regular intervals for adjustments. Do not leave the practice without checking at reception to see if you require another appointment.

Please sign this form if you understand the treatment that has been explained to you and if you are willing to proceed with that treatment.

I certify that I have read or have had read to me the contents of this form and do realize the risks and limitations involved, and consent to the orthodontic treatment that has been explained to me.

In signing this form I also consent to the taking of photographs, study models and x-rays before, during and after orthodontic treatment to assist in the planning and progress treatment objectives. If the case proves to be of special scientific interest, the orthodontist reserves the right to present the records in scientific papers or demonstrations to the profession, with your permission.

We occasionally place photographic records in practice journals for demonstration purposes. These pictures are sometimes shown to other patients in order to demonstrate the benefits and results achieved with orthodontic treatment. If you have an objection to this please tick the box and we will not display your photographs. ☐

You will be given a copy of our Practice Privacy Policy to read at your initial appointment. This document outlines what our policies are, how we protect and process your data and what your rights are in relation to your data. Please read it carefully. Your signature below will also confirm your acceptance of this policy. You are entitled to see the policy at any time.

Patient name (please print)	
Patient signature	
Parent/Guardian name (please print)	
Parent/Guardian signature	
Date signed	

Staff use only Patient number
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